DELIVERABLE 7

CLIENT COMMUNICATION & ENGAGEMENT ETHICS SOP

Prepared by Aimax Digital

For Luxe by Madiha — Clothing Brand

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Review cycle	Annually and after a significant client issue or process change

DESIGN STANDARD: White backgrounds with blue headings, table headers, borders, and accents only.

1. Purpose and scope

This SOP sets the minimum ethical and professional standards for communicating with clients, prospects, customers, and business partners. It applies to anyone representing Luxe by Madiha and, where relevant, to Aimax Digital when delivering agreed services for the brand. It covers the full client journey from first contact through onboarding, service delivery, complaint handling, and offboarding.

2. Core principles

- Be honest, accurate, respectful, responsive, and clear.
- Set realistic expectations and disclose material limitations, dependencies, costs, and risks.
- Protect client information and use it only for authorized purposes.
- Keep appropriate written records of requirements, approvals, changes, and commitments.
- Treat all clients fairly and avoid discrimination, pressure tactics, misleading claims, or retaliation for complaints.

3. First contact and qualification

At first contact, introduce yourself and the organization, explain the purpose of the conversation, ask permission to collect relevant details, and identify the best contact channel. Avoid promising results before understanding the request. Record only information needed to assess and respond to the enquiry.

Initial enquiry checklist

- Client / organization name and authorized contact.
- Main need, objective, desired outcome, and reason for enquiry.
- Required services or products, expected deliverables, and intended audience.
- Desired start date, deadline, budget range if the client chooses to share it, and decision process.
- Relevant constraints, dependencies, approvals, and preferred communication method.
- Next step, responsible person, and expected response date.

4. Client onboarding and needs assessment

Before work begins, confirm the scope, stakeholders, communication contacts, approval process, payment terms, delivery milestones, and any information the client must provide. Ask clarifying questions and summarize the client's requirements in writing. Distinguish confirmed requirements from assumptions that still need approval.

Onboarding item	Minimum standard
Scope and deliverables	List included work, quantities, formats, exclusions, and acceptance criteria.
Timeline	Identify milestones, review periods, client dependencies, and approval deadlines.
Commercial terms	Confirm fees, taxes where applicable, payment schedule, expenses, and change-request process.
Communication	Name the main contact, backup contact, approved channels, and expected response times.
Access and information	Request only necessary access; use approved secure sharing methods and least-privilege access.
Approval to start	Obtain written acceptance of the proposal or other agreed contract before commencing chargeable work.

5. Proposals, quotations, and service descriptions

Proposals and quotations must be clear, specific, and consistent with what the business can reasonably deliver. Use written approval for scope and price before work starts.

Every proposal or quotation should state, as relevant:

- Client name, issue date, proposal/quotation reference, and validity period.
- Objectives, scope, deliverables, quantities, and exclusions.
- Fees, payment schedule, applicable taxes, third-party costs, and any recurring charges.
- Timeline, milestones, client responsibilities, and assumptions.
- Revision limits, acceptance criteria, cancellation terms, and how scope changes are priced.
- Any material risks, dependencies, limitations, or results that cannot be guaranteed.
- Acceptance method and authorized approver.

Never fabricate testimonials, results, qualifications, availability, case studies, or client references. Do not describe a service as included if it is chargeable separately. If an error is found, notify the client promptly and issue a corrected version with the changes identified.

6. Response-time standards and follow-up

Situation	Default standard
New enquiry	Acknowledge within one business day; provide an answer or a realistic next-update time.
Active client message	Acknowledge within one business day during agreed business hours.
Urgent service issue	Use the agreed urgent channel and notify the accountable lead promptly.
Proposal / quotation follow-up	Follow up 2–3 business days after sending, unless the client specified another date.
Pending client approval	Send a polite reminder near the agreed deadline; clarify impact if delayed.
Complex request	Confirm receipt and state what needs checking and when the client can expect an update.
Complaint	Acknowledge within one business day where practical; assess urgency immediately if safety, privacy, or major service impact is involved.

These are default standards, not a promise of 24/7 availability. Confirm business hours, holidays, escalation contacts, and any service-specific commitments at onboarding. Avoid repeated follow-ups after a client declines or asks to stop.

7. Meetings and meeting minutes

Send an agenda for planned meetings and arrive prepared. Listen actively, avoid interrupting, and distinguish facts from assumptions. Do not record a meeting without appropriate authorization and any required notice or consent.

Meeting minutes should normally be sent within one business day and include:

- Date, attendees, and meeting purpose.
- Key points and confirmed decisions.
- Actions, owners, and deadlines.
- Open questions, risks, dependencies, and items requiring approval.
- Next meeting or check-in date, if applicable.

8. Honesty in pricing, timelines, and commitments

• Quote only prices and terms that have been approved by an authorized person.
• Explain what is included and excluded, including third-party fees, delivery costs, taxes where applicable, and recurring charges.
• Do not promise guaranteed sales, reach, engagement, delivery dates, or other outcomes that depend on external factors unless a specific guarantee is authorized and documented.
• Base timelines on realistic capacity, client approvals, stock, supplier performance, and other known dependencies.
• Tell the client promptly when a delay, cost change, error, or scope risk emerges; explain the impact and propose options.
• Obtain written approval before starting out-of-scope work or charging additional fees.
• Never conceal material errors or pressure clients into unnecessary purchases.

9. Client confidentiality and privacy

Collect and retain only information needed for a legitimate business purpose. Restrict access to authorized people, use approved storage and sharing tools, verify recipients before sending files, and follow the company's retention and deletion process. Do not disclose client lists, campaign results, commercial terms, personal details, credentials, designs, or unpublished plans without authorization. Use client names, logos, testimonials, or work samples in marketing only with documented permission.

If information is sent to the wrong person, lost, accessed without authorization, or otherwise exposed, report it promptly through the designated incident process. Do not independently conceal or delete evidence of the incident.

10. Professional boundaries and conflict of interest

Maintain courteous, business-focused relationships. Do not use a client relationship for personal pressure, inappropriate personal contact, gifts or benefits that could compromise impartial judgment, or unauthorized access to client accounts. Disclose actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest to management as soon as identified.

Examples include a personal or financial interest in a supplier, working for a direct competitor where confidentiality could be affected, accepting an undisclosed commission, or making decisions that benefit a friend or relative. Management should document the disclosure and decide whether safeguards, reassignment, approval, or withdrawal from the matter is required.

11. Complaint handling and escalation

Stage	Required action
1. Receive	Listen calmly, thank the client for raising the issue, and avoid blame or argument.
2. Record	Log the date, client, issue, impact, relevant evidence, requested resolution, and responsible owner.
3. Acknowledge	Confirm receipt, explain the next step, and give a realistic update timeframe.
4. Investigate	Review records fairly, consult relevant staff, and identify the cause without making unsupported promises.
5. Resolve	Offer an appropriate remedy within authority; obtain approval for refunds, credits, rework, or contract changes.
6. Confirm and learn	Tell the client the outcome, record acceptance or remaining concerns, and identify preventive action.

12. Escalation levels

Level	Examples	Escalation route
Level 1 — Routine	Minor misunderstanding, simple status request, or fixable service issue.	Assigned account/contact owner; respond and resolve within agreed service expectations.
Level 2 — Significant	Repeated failure, missed milestone, disputed fee, unresolved complaint, or risk to client relationship.	Team lead / management; create an action plan and communicate the next update date.
Level 3 — Critical	Suspected data breach, fraud, serious misconduct, legal threat, safety issue, or material financial/reputational risk.	Senior management and the designated privacy, security, or legal contact as appropriate; act promptly to contain risk.

If the complaint concerns the person who would normally receive it, the client or staff member should be able to escalate to another appropriate manager. Do not retaliate against a client or employee for raising a concern in good faith.

13. Feedback and satisfaction tracking

Request feedback at appropriate milestones, after delivery, and at the end of an engagement. Keep questions brief and avoid pressuring clients to provide positive feedback or public testimonials.

Suggested measures:

- Client satisfaction rating (e.g., 1–5) and optional comments.
- On-time delivery and completion against agreed scope.
- Number and type of complaints, resolution time, and repeat issues.
- Client retention, renewal, repeat purchase, or referral rate where relevant.
- Feedback themes and improvement actions, with an owner and due date.

Review feedback monthly or quarterly depending on volume. Share only aggregated or authorized feedback internally where possible, and obtain permission before using identifiable comments in promotional materials.

14. Client offboarding and closure

When work ends, confirm the final deliverables, outstanding actions, final invoice or balance, handover arrangements, and effective end date. Return or securely transfer client-owned files and assets as agreed; revoke access no longer needed; preserve records required by contract or law; and securely delete other client information according to the approved retention policy.

Send a professional closure message summarizing completed work, remaining items, support or warranty arrangements if applicable, and the correct contact for future enquiries. Request optional feedback without pressure. Do not retain or reuse confidential materials, client credentials, designs, or personal data beyond authorized purposes.

15. Records and responsibilities

Record	Minimum content / owner
Client / enquiry record	Contact details needed for service, needs, source, next action, and owner — assigned client contact.
Proposal / quotation	Version, scope, fees, assumptions, validity, and written approval — authorized sales/management contact.
Meeting minutes / decisions	Attendees, decisions, actions, owners, deadlines — organizer or assigned note-taker.
Complaint log	Issue, dates, evidence, actions, resolution, and preventive measures — designated complaint owner.
Feedback / closure	Satisfaction feedback, final handover, access removal, and outstanding balance — account owner / operations.

16. Training, review, and approval

Relevant personnel should receive this SOP during onboarding and after material changes. Review the policy annually and after a significant client incident, process change, or change in applicable legal requirements. Management should confirm actual business hours, named escalation contacts, privacy procedures, and contractual terms before adoption.

Approval	Name / signature	Date
Luxe by Madiha — Authorized Representative	[Enter]	[Enter]
Aimax Digital — Authorized Representative	[Enter]	[Enter]

Document note: This is an operational policy template. It should be aligned with signed client contracts, actual service capacity, and applicable law before implementation.